

# 14. Active Passive Voice

## DEFINITION

Voice in grammar refers to the form of a verb that shows whether the subject of a sentence performs an action or receives it. When the subject does the action, the sentence is said to be in Active Voice, and when the subject receives the action, the sentence is said to be in Passive Voice. The choice of voice changes the focus of the sentence, either highlighting the doer of the action or the action itself. This shift in focus is important because it helps the speaker or writer decide what information should be emphasized. Understanding voice helps students write clearer sentences and improve their comprehension in reading and writing tasks.

*Active: The teacher explains the lesson. Passive: The lesson is explained by the teacher.*

*Active: Riya cleans the classroom. Passive: The classroom is cleaned by Riya.*

*Active: The boy kicks the ball. Passive: The ball is kicked by the boy.*

*Active: The gardener waters the plants. Passive: The plants are watered by the gardener.*

*Active: The principal announces the holiday. Passive: The holiday is announced by the principal.*

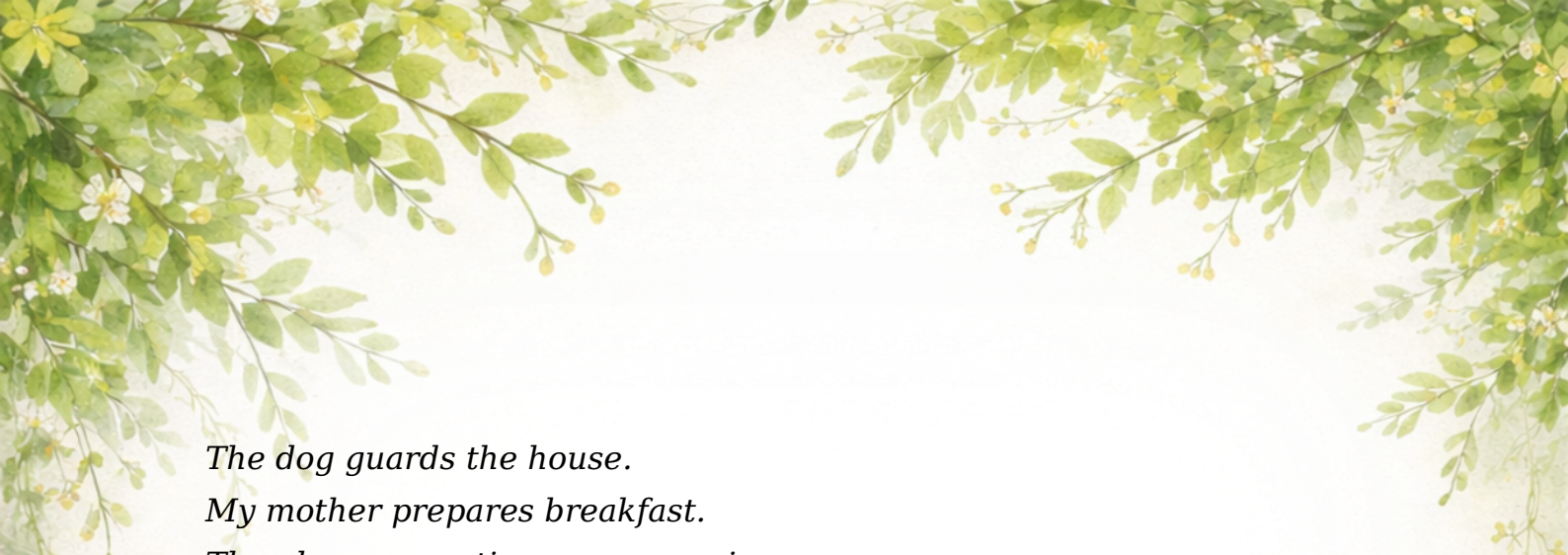
## ACTIVE VOICE

Active Voice is commonly used in daily communication and writing because it directly states who performs an action. In this voice, the subject is active and clearly connected to the verb. Sentences in active voice are usually shorter, clearer, and easier to understand. This voice is preferred in storytelling, instructions, and examinations because it sounds natural and direct. Learning active voice helps students express ideas confidently and precisely.

## DEFINITION OF ACTIVE VOICE

Active Voice is a form of sentence in which the subject performs the action expressed by the verb. The subject comes before the verb and is clearly responsible for the action. This structure makes the sentence direct and strong in meaning. Active voice is commonly used because it avoids confusion about who is doing what. It is especially useful when clarity and responsibility are important.

*The student writes an essay.*



*The dog guards the house.  
My mother prepares breakfast.  
The players practice every morning.  
The shopkeeper opens the store early.*

## **USES OF ACTIVE VOICE**

Active Voice is used when the speaker wants to clearly show who is doing the action. It is preferred in instructions, rules, and storytelling because it sounds lively and engaging. This voice makes sentences simple and easy to understand for readers. It is also useful in examinations because it reduces ambiguity. Active voice helps in effective communication by keeping the focus on the doer.

*The teacher checks the notebooks.  
The children follow the rules.  
The driver stops the bus.  
She answers all the questions.  
The scientist conducts the experiment.*

## **PASSIVE VOICE**

Passive Voice is used when the focus is on the action rather than the doer. In this voice, the subject receives the action of the verb. The doer may be mentioned using “by” or may be omitted if it is unknown or unimportant. Passive voice is often used in formal writing, notices, and scientific descriptions. Understanding passive voice helps students vary sentence structure and focus.

## **DEFINITION OF PASSIVE VOICE**

Passive Voice is a form of sentence in which the subject receives the action performed by the verb. The object of the active sentence becomes the subject in the passive sentence. The doer of the action may be added with “by” or left out if not needed. Passive voice is useful when the action is more important than the doer. It is commonly found in reports and official writing.

*The room is cleaned every day.*



*The letter was posted yesterday.*  
*The match was won by our team.*  
*The cake is baked by my sister.*  
*The bridge was repaired last year.*

## USES OF PASSIVE VOICE

Passive Voice is used when the doer of the action is unknown or not important. It is also used when the speaker wants to emphasize the action or result. This voice is common in scientific experiments and official notices. Passive voice helps maintain a formal tone in writing. It is useful when focusing on processes rather than people.

*The rules are followed strictly.*  
*The window was broken at night.*  
*The homework is checked daily.*  
*The road is being repaired.*  
*The results were announced today.*

## FORMATION OF PASSIVE VOICE

Passive voice is formed by using a suitable form of the verb “be” along with the past participle of the main verb. The tense of the sentence must be carefully maintained while changing from active to passive. The object of the active sentence becomes the subject of the passive sentence. The subject of the active sentence may be added with “by” if required. Correct formation ensures clarity and grammatical accuracy.

*Active: She writes a letter. Passive: A letter is written by her.*  
*Active: They completed the work. Passive: The work was completed by them.*  
*Active: He is painting the wall. Passive: The wall is being painted by him.*  
*Active: We have solved the problem. Passive: The problem has been solved by us.*  
*Active: The guard will lock the gate. Passive: The gate will be locked by the guard.*

## ACTIVE TO PASSIVE VOICE (TENSE-WISE)

Changing active voice to passive voice depends greatly on the tense of the sentence. Each tense has a specific structure in the passive form. The helping verb changes according to tense and number. The main verb is always used in its past participle form. Understanding tense-wise conversion helps students avoid common mistakes.

### PRESENT INDEFINITE TENSE

In the present indefinite tense, the passive voice is formed using “is” or “are” with the past participle of the verb. The object of the active sentence becomes the subject of the passive sentence. The tense remains the same while the verb form changes. Singular subjects take “is” and plural subjects take “are.” This tense is commonly used for habitual actions.

*Active: She reads a book. Passive: A book is read by her.*

*Active: They play cricket. Passive: Cricket is played by them.*

*Active: He repairs watches. Passive: Watches are repaired by him.*

*Active: The teacher teaches English. Passive: English is taught by the teacher.*

*Active: We celebrate festivals. Passive: Festivals are celebrated by us.*

### PRESENT CONTINUOUS TENSE

In the present continuous tense, the passive voice uses “is being” or “are being” with the past participle. The action must be ongoing at the time of speaking. The object of the active sentence becomes the subject in the passive sentence. The doer may be mentioned using “by.” This tense shows an action in progress.

*Active: She is writing a story. Passive: A story is being written by her.*

*Active: They are cleaning the hall. Passive: The hall is being cleaned by them.*

*Active: He is watching a movie. Passive: A movie is being watched by him.*

*Active: The workers are building a bridge. Passive: A bridge is being built by the workers.*

*Active: We are preparing lunch. Passive: Lunch is being prepared by us.*

## **PRESENT PERFECT TENSE**

In the present perfect tense, the passive voice uses “has been” or “have been” with the past participle. This tense shows an action that has been completed recently. The subject and object interchange their positions. The helping verb depends on whether the new subject is singular or plural. This form highlights the result of an action.

*Active: She has completed the project. Passive: The project has been completed by her.*

*Active: They have painted the room. Passive: The room has been painted by them.*

*Active: He has written a letter. Passive: A letter has been written by him.*

*Active: We have cleaned the park. Passive: The park has been cleaned by us.*

*Active: The chef has prepared the dish. Passive: The dish has been prepared by the chef.*

## **PAST INDEFINITE TENSE**

In the past indefinite tense, the passive voice uses “was” or “were” with the past participle. This tense shows an action completed in the past. The object of the active sentence becomes the subject of the passive sentence. The helping verb depends on the number of the new subject. This tense is very common in narratives.

*Active: She wrote a poem. Passive: A poem was written by her.*

*Active: They won the match. Passive: The match was won by them.*

*Active: He fixed the chair. Passive: The chair was fixed by him.*

*Active: We visited the museum. Passive: The museum was visited by us.*

*Active: The police caught the thief. Passive: The thief was caught by the police.*

## **PAST CONTINUOUS TENSE**



In the past continuous tense, the passive voice uses “was being” or “were being” with the past participle. This tense shows an action that was in progress in the past. The object of the active sentence becomes the subject of the passive sentence. The structure of the sentence changes but the tense remains the same. This form is less common but important.

*Active: She was drawing a picture. Passive: A picture was being drawn by her.*

*Active: They were repairing the road. Passive: The road was being repaired by them.*

*Active: He was reading a novel. Passive: A novel was being read by him.*

*Active: We were watching the match. Passive: The match was being watched by us.*

*Active: The workers were loading goods. Passive: Goods were being loaded by the workers.*

## PAST PERFECT TENSE

In the past perfect tense, the passive voice uses “had been” with the past participle. This tense shows an action completed before another action in the past. The object of the active sentence becomes the subject in the passive sentence. The helping verb “had” remains unchanged. This tense focuses on the earlier action.

*Active: She had finished the work. Passive: The work had been finished by her.*

*Active: They had cleaned the room. Passive: The room had been cleaned by them.*

*Active: He had delivered the parcel. Passive: The parcel had been delivered by him.*

*Active: We had solved the puzzle. Passive: The puzzle had been solved by us.*

*Active: The team had achieved the target. Passive: The target had been achieved by the team.*

## FUTURE INDEFINITE TENSE

In the future indefinite tense, the passive voice uses “will be” with the past participle. This tense refers to actions that will happen in the future. The object of the active sentence becomes the subject of the passive sentence. The helping verb “will” remains the same. This form is commonly used in promises and plans.

*Active: She will write a letter. Passive: A letter will be written by her.*

*Active: They will organize the event. Passive: The event will be organized by them.*

*Active: He will repair the machine. Passive: The machine will be repaired by him.*

*Active: We will complete the task. Passive: The task will be completed by us.*

*Active: The company will launch a product. Passive: A product will be launched by the company.*

## **FUTURE PERFECT TENSE**

In the future perfect tense, the passive voice uses “will have been” with the past participle. This tense shows an action that will be completed before a specific time in the future. The object of the active sentence becomes the subject of the passive sentence. The verb structure becomes slightly longer but clear. This tense highlights completion.

*Active: She will have completed the course. Passive: The course will have been completed by her.*

*Active: They will have built the house. Passive: The house will have been built by them.*

*Active: He will have written the report. Passive: The report will have been written by him.*

*Active: We will have cleaned the area. Passive: The area will have been cleaned by us.*

*Active: The team will have won the trophy. Passive: The trophy will have been won by the team.*

## **ACTIVE TO PASSIVE VOICE (PRONOUN-WISE)**

While changing active voice to passive voice, pronouns must be changed correctly. Subject pronouns in the active sentence often become object pronouns after “by” in the passive sentence. Similarly, object pronouns in active sentences become subject pronouns in passive sentences. Incorrect pronoun changes can make sentences ungrammatical. Careful attention to pronouns ensures accuracy.

*Active: She helps me. Passive: I am helped by her.*

*Active: They invite us. Passive: We are invited by them.*

*Active: He teaches her. Passive: She is taught by him.*

*Active: We support him. Passive: He is supported by us.*

*Active: I praise them. Passive: They are praised by me.*

## ACTIVE TO PASSIVE VOICE (MODAL-WISE)

Sentences containing modal verbs form the passive voice using “modal + be + past participle.” The modal verb remains unchanged in the passive sentence. The object of the active sentence becomes the subject of the passive sentence. This structure applies to modals like can, may, must, should, and will. Understanding this pattern helps in correct conversion.

*Active: She can solve the problem. Passive: The problem can be solved by her.*

*Active: They must follow the rules. Passive: The rules must be followed by them.*

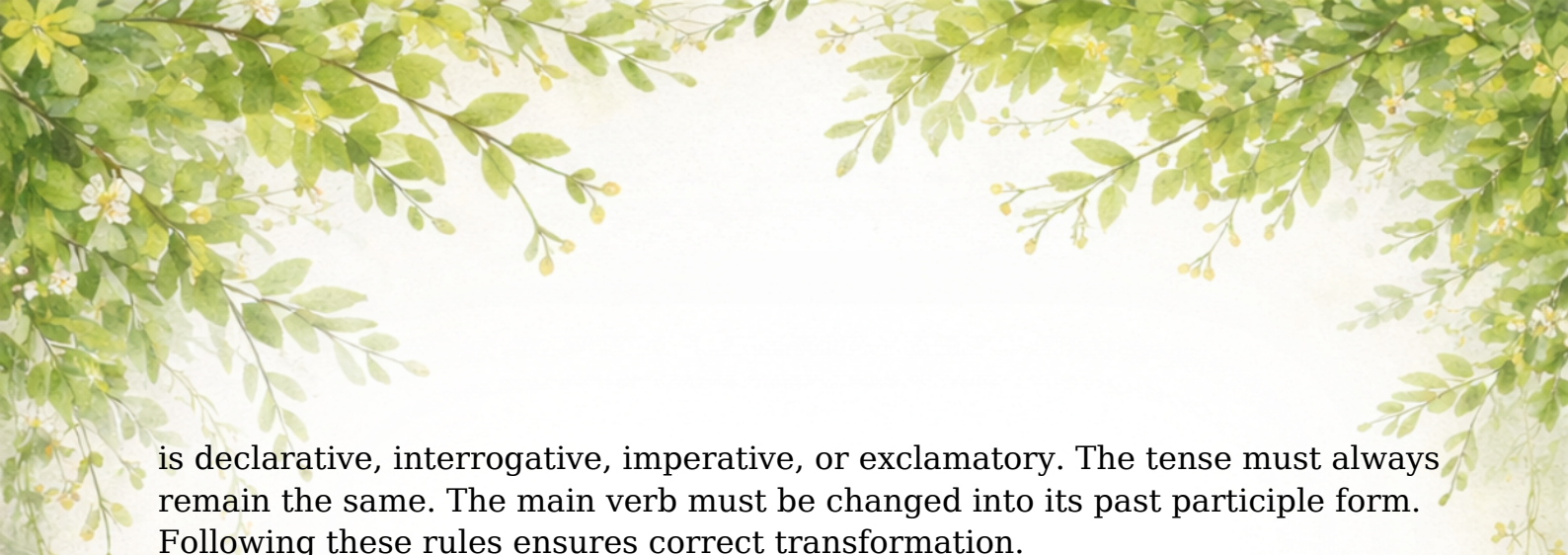
*Active: He should complete the work. Passive: The work should be completed by him.*

*Active: We may invite the guest. Passive: The guest may be invited by us.*

*Active: You will finish the task. Passive: The task will be finished by you.*

## RULES FOR CHANGING ACTIVE TO PASSIVE (SENTENCE-WISE)

Different types of sentences require special attention while changing from active to passive voice. The structure may change depending on whether the sentence



is declarative, interrogative, imperative, or exclamatory. The tense must always remain the same. The main verb must be changed into its past participle form. Following these rules ensures correct transformation.

## DECLARATIVE SENTENCES

Declarative sentences state facts or opinions and are easily changed into passive voice. The subject and object interchange their positions. The verb is changed according to tense. The meaning of the sentence remains the same. This is the most common type of conversion.

*Active: The teacher praised the student. Passive: The student was praised by the teacher.*

*Active: She opened the door. Passive: The door was opened by her.*

*Active: They solved the problem. Passive: The problem was solved by them.*

*Active: He wrote the answer. Passive: The answer was written by him.*

*Active: We planted the tree. Passive: The tree was planted by us.*

## INTERROGATIVE SENTENCES

Interrogative sentences ask questions and must retain their question form in the passive voice. The helping verb usually comes before the subject. The question mark remains at the end. The object of the active sentence becomes the subject in the passive sentence. Care is needed to maintain clarity.

*Active: Did she complete the work? Passive: Was the work completed by her?*

*Active: Is he reading the book? Passive: Is the book being read by him?*

*Active: Has she written the letter? Passive: Has the letter been written by her?*

*Active: Will they organize the event? Passive: Will the event be organized by them?*

*Active: Was he painting the wall? Passive: Was the wall being painted by him?*

## IMPERATIVE SENTENCES



Imperative sentences give commands, requests, or advice. These sentences are usually converted into passive using “let” or “should be.” The subject is often implied. The tone of the sentence should be maintained. This type of conversion is slightly different from others.

*Active: Close the door. Passive: Let the door be closed.*

*Active: Complete the homework. Passive: Let the homework be completed.*

*Active: Follow the rules. Passive: Let the rules be followed.*

*Active: Clean the room. Passive: Let the room be cleaned.*

*Active: Switch off the lights. Passive: Let the lights be switched off.*

## EXCLAMATORY SENTENCES

Exclamatory sentences express strong feelings and emotions. While changing into passive voice, the emotion must be preserved. The structure may change, but the sense remains the same. Exclamatory words are retained. Careful conversion is required.

*Active: How beautifully she sang the song! Passive: How beautifully the song was sung by her!*

*Active: What a mistake he made! Passive: What a mistake was made by him!*

*Active: How neatly they arranged the hall! Passive: How neatly the hall was arranged by them!*

*Active: What a goal he scored! Passive: What a goal was scored by him!*

*Active: How quickly she solved the puzzle! Passive: How quickly the puzzle was solved by her!*

## QUASI-PASSIVE FORMS

Quasi-passive forms look like passive sentences but do not have clear active forms. These sentences often use adjectives or participles. They focus on the state rather than the action. The doer is usually not mentioned. Such constructions are common in English usage.

*The book is interesting.*

*The door is closed.*

*The food is cooked.*

*The room is decorated.*

*The task is finished.*

## MISCELLANEOUS SENTENCES

Some sentences have special structures such as two objects, reporting verbs, or infinitives that need careful handling. Either object may become the subject in some cases. The verb pattern may change slightly. Such sentences are common in exams. Proper understanding avoids confusion.

*Active: She gave me a gift. Passive: I was given a gift by her.*

*Active: They told us the news. Passive: We were told the news by them.*

*Active: He asked me a question. Passive: I was asked a question by him.*

*Active: The teacher advised the students to work hard. Passive: The students were advised by the teacher to work hard.*

*Active: She promised him help. Passive: He was promised help by her.*

## COMMON ERRORS TO AVOID

Students often make mistakes while changing active voice into passive voice. Common errors include using the wrong tense or incorrect helping verbs. Some students forget to change pronouns properly. Others use the wrong past participle form of the verb. Avoiding these mistakes improves accuracy.

*Incorrect: The work is completed by she. Correct: The work is completed by her.*

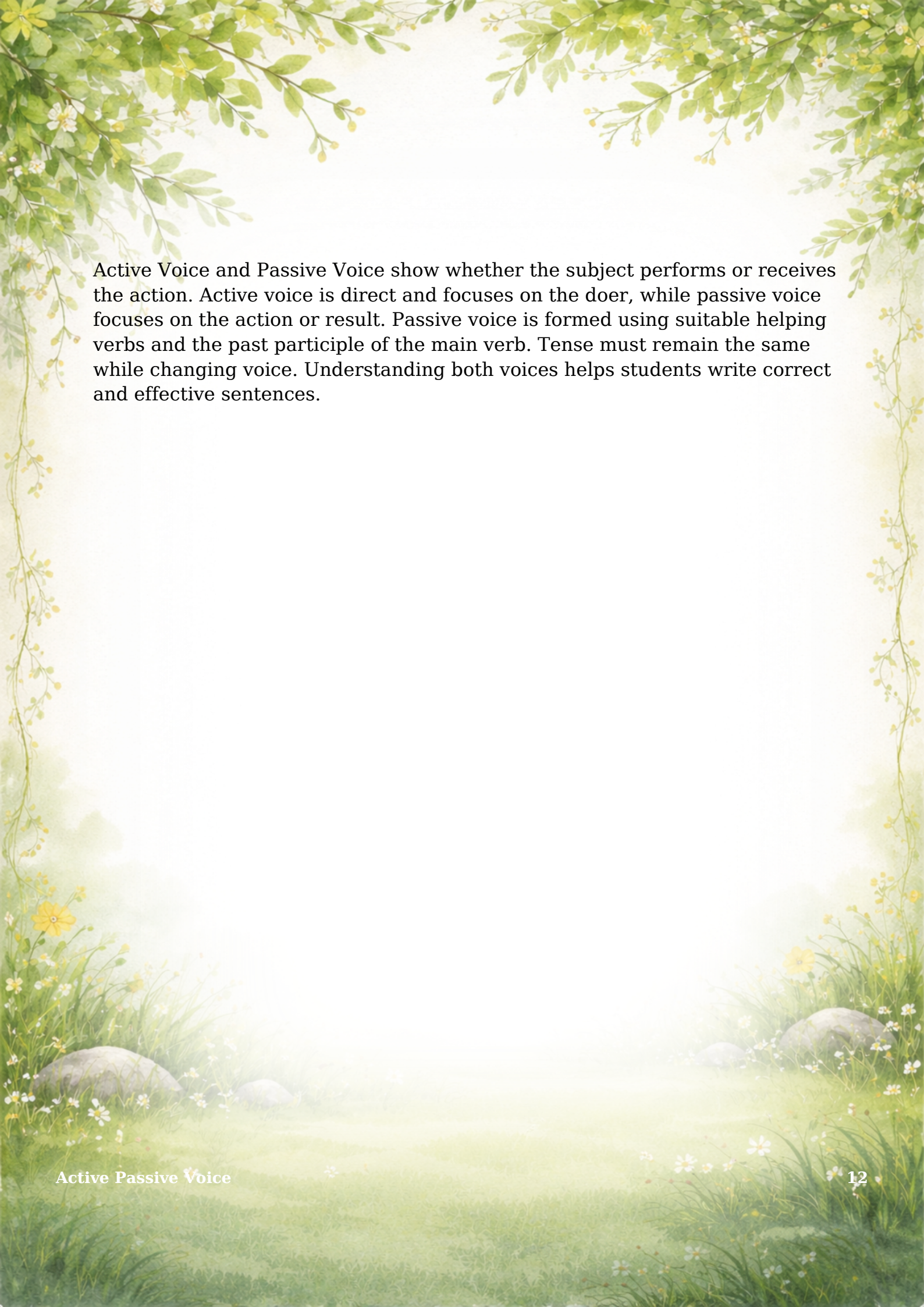
*Incorrect: The match was win by them. Correct: The match was won by them.*

*Incorrect: A letter is wrote by him. Correct: A letter is written by him.*

*Incorrect: The food has cook by mother. Correct: The food has been cooked by mother.*

*Incorrect: The door was open by me. Correct: The door was opened by me.*

## SUMMARY



Active Voice and Passive Voice show whether the subject performs or receives the action. Active voice is direct and focuses on the doer, while passive voice focuses on the action or result. Passive voice is formed using suitable helping verbs and the past participle of the main verb. Tense must remain the same while changing voice. Understanding both voices helps students write correct and effective sentences.

# Exercises

## 1. Change the following sentences into Passive Voice - 10 sentences

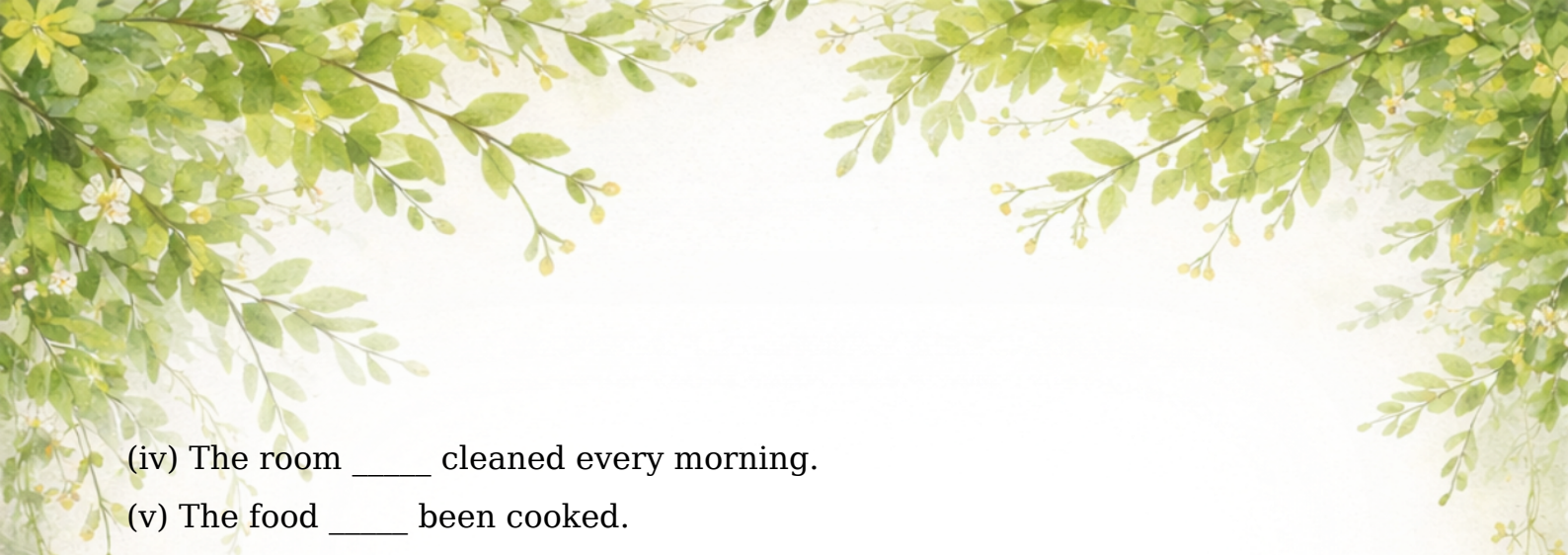
- (i) The teacher explains the topic.
- (ii) She washes the clothes.
- (iii) They are repairing the car.
- (iv) He has finished the work.
- (v) We will organize the program.
- (vi) The guard closed the gate.
- (vii) The chef is cooking the food.
- (viii) She had written a letter.
- (ix) They will complete the project.
- (x) The boys play football.

## 2. Change the following sentences into Active Voice - 10 sentences

- (i) The room is cleaned every day.
- (ii) The match was won by our team.
- (iii) The homework has been completed by her.
- (iv) The door was opened by the guard.
- (v) The song is being sung by the child.
- (vi) The road was repaired by the workers.
- (vii) The prizes will be distributed by the principal.
- (viii) The lesson was explained by the teacher.
- (ix) The cake has been baked by my mother.
- (x) The book will be read by him.

## 3. Fill in the blanks with correct verb form - 10 blanks

- (i) The work \_\_\_\_\_ completed by her.
- (ii) The letters \_\_\_\_\_ being posted.
- (iii) The match \_\_\_\_\_ won by the team.

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- (iv) The room \_\_\_\_ cleaned every morning.  
(v) The food \_\_\_\_ been cooked.  
(vi) The door \_\_\_\_ closed by him.  
(vii) The lesson \_\_\_\_ explained by the teacher.  
(viii) The prize \_\_\_\_ be given tomorrow.  
(ix) The rules \_\_\_\_ followed strictly.  
(x) The wall \_\_\_\_ being painted.

#### **4. Choose the correct option - 8 MCQs**

##### **1. The passive form of “She writes a letter” is:**

- (i) (a) A letter was written by her  
(ii) (b) A letter is written by her  
(iii) (c) A letter has written by her  
(iv) (d) A letter is being written by her

##### **2. Which tense uses “has been” in passive voice?**

- (i) (a) Past indefinite  
(ii) (b) Present perfect  
(iii) (c) Future indefinite  
(iv) (d) Past continuous

##### **3. The passive form of “They will complete the work” is:**

- (i) (a) The work completes by them  
(ii) (b) The work will be completed by them  
(iii) (c) The work is completed by them  
(iv) (d) The work was completed by them

##### **4. Which sentence is in passive voice?**

**5. The correct passive form of “He is painting the wall” is:**

- (i) (a) The wall was painted by him
- (ii) (b) The wall is painted by him
- (iii) (c) The wall is being painted by him
- (iv) (d) The wall has been painted by him

**6. Which helping verb is used in past perfect passive?**

- (i) (a) was
- (ii) (b) were
- (iii) (c) had been
- (iv) (d) has been

**7. The passive form of “Close the window” is:**

- (a) The window closed
- (b) Let the window be closed
- (c) The window is closing
- (d) Let close the window

**8. Which sentence cannot have a clear active form?**

- (i) (a) The book is interesting
- (ii) (b) She reads a book
- (iii) (c) He wrote a letter
- (iv) (d) They played chess

**5. Identify whether the sentence is Active or Passive - 10 sentences**

- (i) The letter was posted yesterday.
- (ii) She helps her friend.
- (iii) The room is being cleaned.

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- (iv) They completed the task.  
(v) The food has been cooked.  
(vi) He writes neatly.  
(vii) The gate was locked by the guard.  
(viii) We are watching a movie.  
(ix) The prizes were distributed.  
(x) The child sings well.

### 6. Spot the error and correct it - 10 sentences

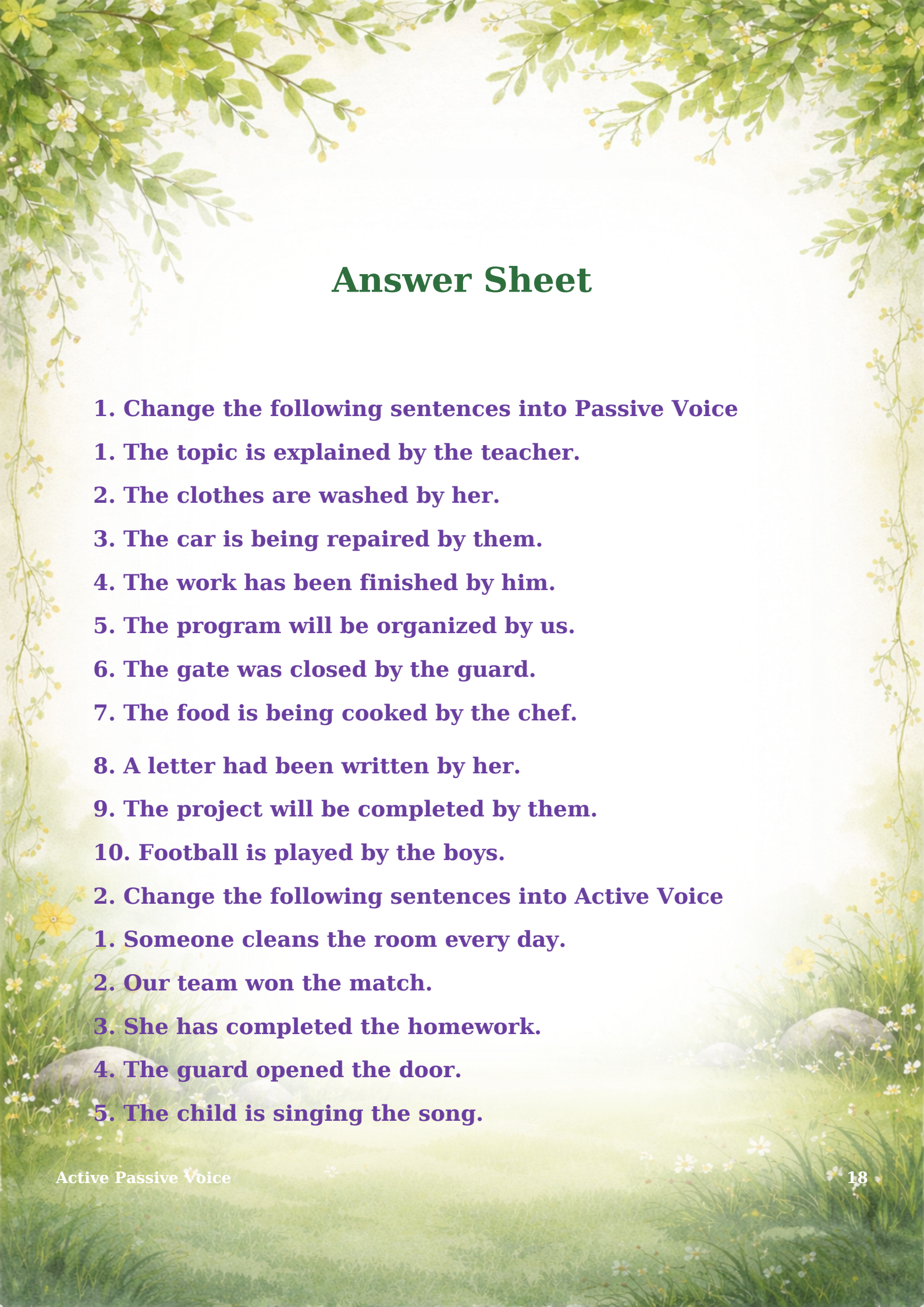
- (i) Incorrect: The work is did by him. Correct: \_\_\_\_\_  
(ii) Incorrect: The match was win by us. Correct: \_\_\_\_\_  
(iii) Incorrect: A letter is wrote by her. Correct: \_\_\_\_\_  
(iv) Incorrect: The food has cook by mother. Correct: \_\_\_\_\_  
(v) Incorrect: The door was open by me. Correct: \_\_\_\_\_  
(vi) Incorrect: The homework is complete by she. Correct: \_\_\_\_\_  
(vii) Incorrect: The wall is being paint by him. Correct: \_\_\_\_\_  
(viii) Incorrect: The book was readed by her. Correct: \_\_\_\_\_  
(ix) Incorrect: The prize will given by teacher. Correct: \_\_\_\_\_  
(x) Incorrect: The room are cleaned daily. Correct: \_\_\_\_\_

### 7. Rewrite the paragraph by changing voice - ONE paragraph of EXACTLY 20 lines

The teacher explains the lesson.  
She gives examples.  
The students listen carefully.  
They ask questions.  
The teacher answers them.  
She writes on the board.  
The students copy the notes.



They complete the exercises.  
The teacher checks the work.  
She corrects mistakes.  
The students learn the rules.  
They practice daily.  
The teacher encourages them.  
She gives homework.  
The students note it down.  
They revise at home.  
The parents support them.  
The school conducts tests.  
The teachers evaluate papers.  
The results motivate students.



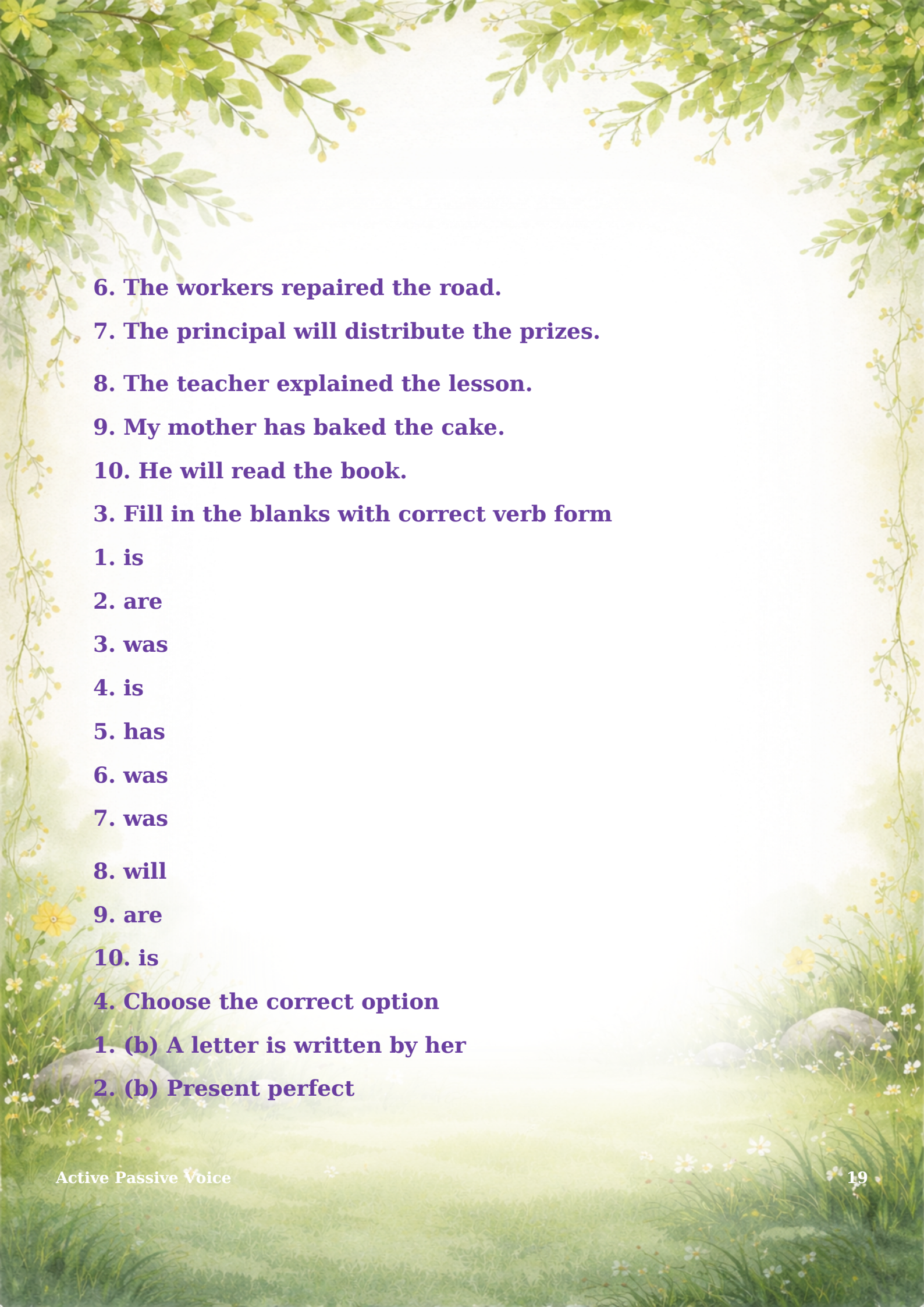
## Answer Sheet

### 1. Change the following sentences into Passive Voice

1. The topic is explained by the teacher.
2. The clothes are washed by her.
3. The car is being repaired by them.
4. The work has been finished by him.
5. The program will be organized by us.
6. The gate was closed by the guard.
7. The food is being cooked by the chef.
8. A letter had been written by her.
9. The project will be completed by them.
10. Football is played by the boys.

### 2. Change the following sentences into Active Voice

1. Someone cleans the room every day.
2. Our team won the match.
3. She has completed the homework.
4. The guard opened the door.
5. The child is singing the song.

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6. The workers repaired the road.
  7. The principal will distribute the prizes.
  8. The teacher explained the lesson.
  9. My mother has baked the cake.
  10. He will read the book.

3. Fill in the blanks with correct verb form

1. is
2. are
3. was
4. is
5. has
6. was
7. was
8. will
9. are
10. is

4. Choose the correct option

1. (b) A letter is written by her
2. (b) Present perfect

**3. (b) The work will be completed by them**

**4. (c) The door is opened**

**5. (c) The wall is being painted by him**

**6. (c) had been**

**7. (b) Let the window be closed**

**8. (a) The book is interesting**

**5. Identify whether the sentence is Active or Passive**

**1. Passive**

**2. Active**

**3. Passive**

**4. Active**

**5. Passive**

**6. Active**

**7. Passive**

**8. Active**

**9. Passive**

**10. Active**

**6. Spot the error and correct it**

(i) Incorrect: The work is did by him. Correct: The work is done by him.

(ii) Incorrect: The match was win by us. Correct: The match was won by us.

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- (iii) Incorrect: A letter is wrote by her. Correct: A letter is written by her.
- (iv) Incorrect: The food has cook by mother. Correct: The food has been cooked by mother.
- (v) Incorrect: The door was open by me. Correct: The door was opened by me.
- (vi) Incorrect: The homework is complete by she. Correct: The homework is completed by her.
- (vii) Incorrect: The wall is being paint by him. Correct: The wall is being painted by him.
- (viii) Incorrect: The book was read by her. Correct: The book was read by her.
- (ix) Incorrect: The prize will given by teacher. Correct: The prize will be given by the teacher.
- (x) Incorrect: The room are cleaned daily. Correct: The room is cleaned daily.

## 7. Rewrite the paragraph by changing voice

The lesson is explained by the teacher.

Examples are given by her.

The students are listened carefully.

Questions are asked by them.

They are answered by the teacher.

The board is written on by her.

The notes are copied by the students.

The exercises are completed by them.

The work is checked by the teacher.

Mistakes are corrected by her.

The rules are learned by the students.

Daily practice is done by them.

They are encouraged by the teacher.

Homework is given by her.

It is noted down by the students.

Revision is done at home by them.

They are supported by the parents.

Tests are conducted by the school.



Papers are evaluated by the teachers.  
The students are motivated by the results.